

Universal Basic Capital: how to build it — and where the capital comes from

Branislav Ambrož · the AGORA project · June 2026 | Predistribution, not redistribution: distribute the asset, not just the income.

The principle

UBI redistributes a **flow** (cash). Universal Basic Capital (UBC) distributes the **asset** — a citizens' stake in the capital stock whose dividend compounds with the economy. An AI advantage is a compounding stock, so a static cash transfer leaves ownership untouched. To share a compounding advantage, distribute ownership.

Where the capital comes from

ranked low → high political friction

- **Equity (scrip) dilution — no cash needed.** Large firms issue ~0.5–1% of new shares/yr into a citizens' fund (Meidner wage-earner funds; IPPR). This is AGORA's in-kind levy τ .
- **Equity for public inputs.** Take a stake in AI firms in return for compute, energy, public data, R&D; and procurement (US equity-sharing talks; OpenAI 'public wealth fund', 2026).
- **Windfall / excess-profit / AI-equity taxes** — recycled *into* the fund, not spent.
- **Rents & royalties, generalised.** Norway/Alaska model on the modern commons: spectrum, data, carbon, and a **land-value tax** (stops cash being recaptured as rent).
- **One-off seed.** State shareholdings, privatisation receipts, or borrow-at-sovereign-rate to invest.
- **Baby bonds.** Seed an account at birth (Connecticut ~\$3,200/child → ~\$10–11k at 18; US 'Trump accounts' \$1,000).

Bottom line: the top routes need no upfront cheque — you claim ownership, you don't spend.

How to build it

- **1. Pick the architecture** — collective dividend fund (Alaska) vs individual accounts (baby bonds) vs hybrid.
- **2. Legislate an independent, ring-fenced vehicle** — arm's-length manager, ethics council, legal lock (Norway GPFG ~\$2T; ~0.04% cost; withdrawals capped at the real return).
- **3. Open the taps small, then ramp** the rate on a schedule.
- **4. Accumulate first** — reinvest and diversify globally; pay out only once the per-capita amount is meaningful.
- **5. Distribute** — equal per-capita dividend (Alaska ~\$1,700/yr) and/or non-tradeable stakes (block cheap sell-offs that re-concentrate ownership).
- **6. Add an EU layer** — a pooled European tranche (via the EIB or a European fund).
- **Bridge:** run cash/services *now* for those displaced today — UBC is generational (its dividend overtakes cash ~year 11).

Four design rules (set by the model)

AGORA, calibrated to Germany, France & Slovakia

- **Reinvest, or it chokes.** Pay out 100% and the UBC economy ends ~20% *smaller* than cash; a reinvesting fund closes the gap — wealth top-10% stays ~20% vs ~55–60% under cash.
- **The dose is country-specific.** DE & FR peak near $\tau \approx 0.5$; Slovakia still gains at 0.6. No single EU-wide rate.
- **Pool for convergence.** Pooling the dividend cut between-country inequality ~60% (DE+FR+SK).
- **It's robust.** Across 100+ random parameter draws per country, UBC's inequality band sits entirely below cash's — the distributions don't overlap.

Sandbox, not oracle — every assumption is visible, sourced and swappable.

Study (DOI): doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20726928 Code + data: github.com/Brano80/agora

Numbers are AGORA model outputs (Germany, France, Slovakia; 30-yr horizon; 2026) — illustrative, conditional, not forecasts.

Sources: AGORA model; Windfall Trust Policy Atlas; IPPR 'Our Common Wealth'; Norway GPFG; Alaska Permanent Fund Corp.; NYT/Forbes (2026).